

WebChat

Status: macOS/iOS SwiftUI chat UI directly communicates with Gateway WebSocket.

What It Is

- Native chat UI for Gateway (no embedded browser, no local static server).
- Uses the same session and routing rules as other channels.
- Deterministic routing: replies always return to WebChat.

Quick Start

1. Enter the root environment (if the application was installed in the root directory using root privileges).

```
sudo su
```

2. Start the Gateway. (Typically, the Gateway starts automatically, so running this command is not necessary.)

openclaw gateway

3. Open the WebChat UI (macOS/iOS app) or the Chat tab within the Control UI.

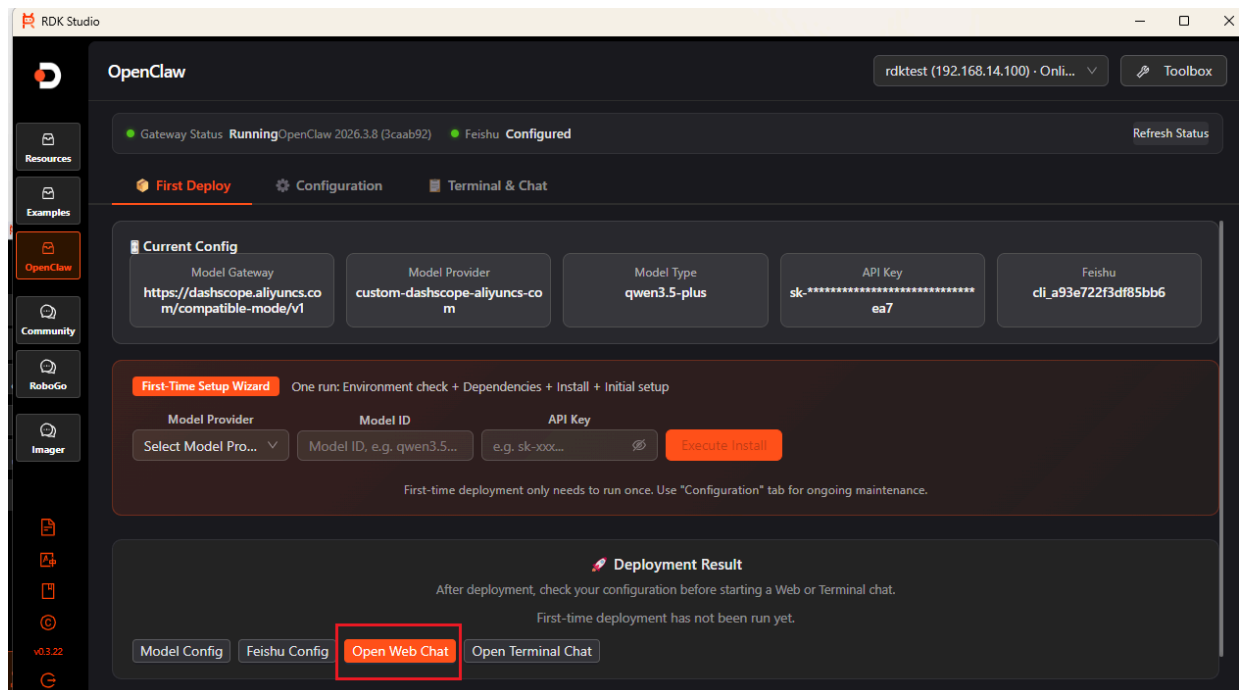
openc1aw dashboard

```
$ openclaw dashboard

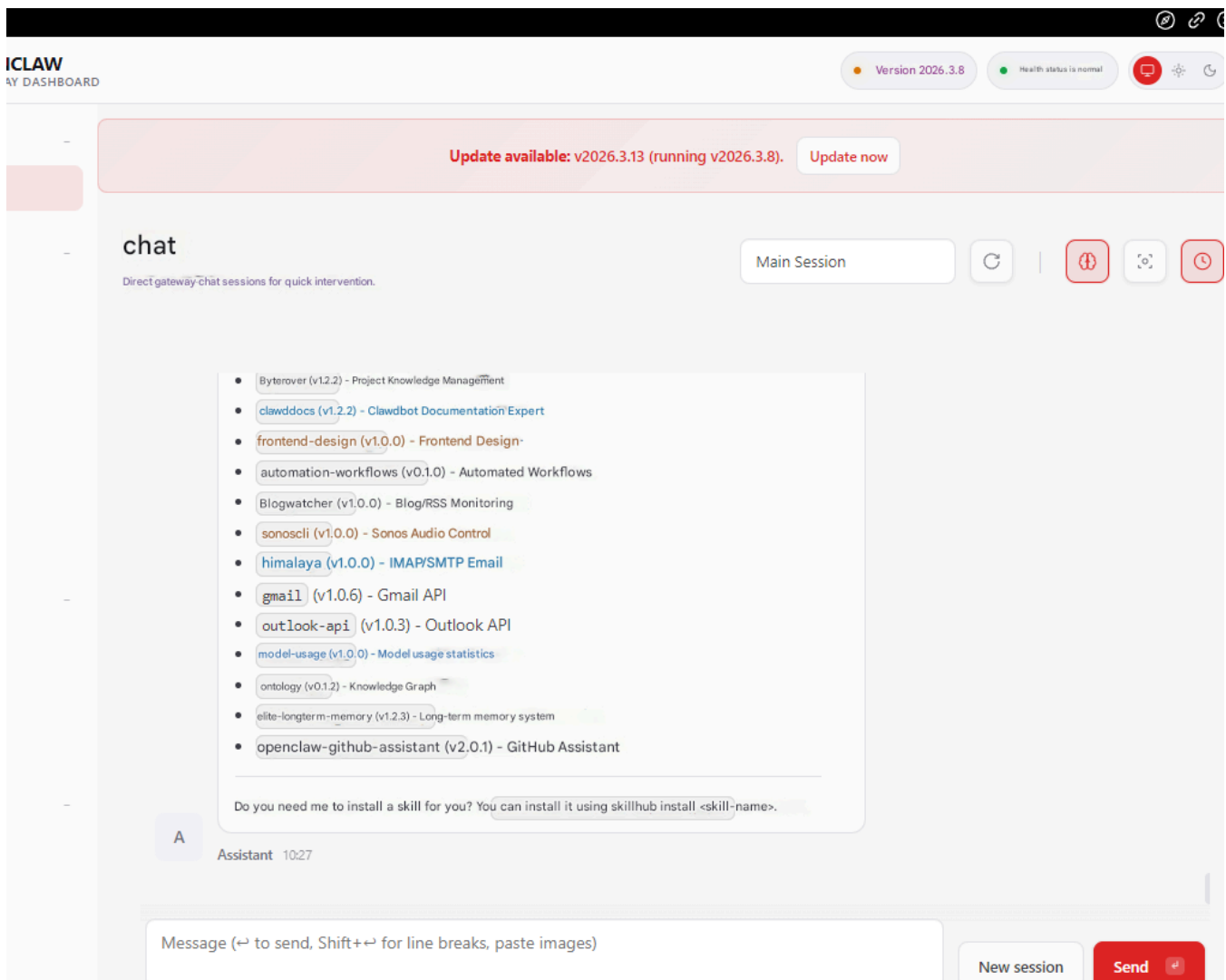
🦋 OpenClaw 2026.3.8 (3caab92) - I'm like tmux: confusing at first, then suddenly you can't live without me.

Dashboard URL: [REDACTED]
Copy to clipboard unavailable.
No GUI detected. Open from your computer:
ssh -N -L [REDACTED]
Then open:
http://localhost:18789/
http://localhost:18789/[REDACTED]
Docs:
https://docs.openclaw.ai/gateway/remote
https://docs.openclaw.ai/web/control-ui
```

1. Or directly enter web dialogue from the first deployment interface



2. Ensure Gateway authentication is configured (required by default, even on loopback).



How It Works (Behavior)

- UI connects to Gateway WebSocket and uses `chat.history`, `chat.send`, and `chat.inject`.

- `chat.inject` directly appends assistant messages to the transcript and broadcasts to UI (no agent run).
- History is always fetched from Gateway (no local file watching).
- If Gateway is unreachable, WebChat is read-only.

Remote Usage

- Remote mode tunnels Gateway WebSocket via SSH/Tailscale.
- You don't need to run a separate WebChat server.

Configuration Reference (WebChat)

Full configuration: [Configuration](#) Channel options:

- There is no dedicated `webchat.*` block. WebChat uses the Gateway endpoints + authentication settings below.

Related global options:

- `gateway.port`, `gateway.bind`: WebSocket host/port.
- `gateway.auth.mode`, `gateway.auth.token`, `gateway.auth.password`: WebSocket authentication.
- `gateway.remote.url`, `gateway.remote.token`, `gateway.remote.password`: Remote Gateway target.
- `session.*`: Session storage and primary key defaults.

For more information about WEB interface, refer to: [WebChat - OpenClaw](#)